

1. Choose one of the following free GPTs - ChatGPT, Copilot or Gemini, or do a Google search asking the following question: "How will AI impact [insert your major or occupational field or job market (whatever is of the most interest to you) in the year [insert your projected graduation year]? Copy and paste the response ensuring that you cite and reference it. **[NOTE - this is the only question in this assignment allowing GPT use]**

When prompted with "How will AI impact information technology in the year 2026?", ChatGPT responded with "Great question — let's look ahead a bit! Here's a snapshot of **how AI is likely to impact the field of Information Technology (IT) by 2026**, based on current trends and projections from industry and academic sources like MIT Sloan and Saanvi Agrawal's Honors Project:

The Impact of AI on Information Technology by 2026

1. Automation of Routine IT Tasks

AI will increasingly automate repetitive and time-consuming tasks in IT, such as:

- Software testing and bug fixing
- System monitoring and incident response
- IT support (e.g., chatbots for Tier 1 helpdesk)

This frees up human IT professionals to focus on **strategic problem-solving and innovation**, aligning with the MIT article's view that AI will *augment* human roles rather than simply replace them.

2. AI-Augmented Cybersecurity

By 2026, AI will be deeply embedded in **cybersecurity operations**:

- Real-time threat detection using machine learning
- Behavior-based anomaly tracking
- Automated incident response and mitigation

The demand for AI-literate cybersecurity specialists — those who understand both the tech and ethical implications — will grow significantly. This ties in with Agrawal's "Sustainer" role: ensuring AI systems behave responsibly and securely.

3. Shift Toward AI Operations (AIOps)

AIOps (Artificial Intelligence for IT Operations) will become standard. These platforms use AI to:

- Analyze massive volumes of data from IT environments
- Predict outages or performance issues
- Automate root cause analysis and resolutions

This moves IT from reactive to **predictive and proactive**, changing how professionals think about infrastructure management.

4. AI-Driven Development (AI DevOps)

- AI will assist in writing, reviewing, and optimizing code (think GitHub Copilot on steroids).
- Developers will work *with* AI as a co-pilot — a key example of the **Human-AI Cooperative** model in Agrawal's framework.

Coding won't disappear, but the **nature of coding** will evolve, with emphasis shifting from syntax to **logic, design, and ethical considerations**.

5. Skills Shift & Emerging Job Roles

By 2026, IT professionals will need to build hybrid skillsets:

- **AI & ML understanding** for integration and oversight
- **Data fluency** to interpret and manage AI outputs
- **Ethical literacy** to manage data bias, privacy, and explainability

New roles could include:

- AI Systems Auditor
- Data Trust Officer
- Machine Learning Infrastructure Engineer

These echo the "Explainer" and "Sustainer" roles highlighted in the MIT Sloan article.

6. Ethical Challenges and Governance

As AI decisions become more embedded in IT systems, professionals will face ethical questions about:

- AI accountability (who's responsible if AI causes an outage or breach?)
- Data use and privacy
- AI bias in algorithms and system recommendations

Agrawal's project emphasizes the need for **moral clarity and transparency** in these tech-human ecosystems.

Conclusion

By 2026, AI will **not replace IT professionals**, but it will **change what it means to work in IT**. From developers and analysts to support teams and security engineers, the focus will shift toward *collaborating with AI* to build smarter, more adaptive, and ethically grounded systems.

In short: The jobs remain — the **skills evolve**" (OpenAI, 2025).

2. Refer to Saanvi's Future of Work and Automation infographic. How would you categorize the work you will be doing: human centric, human led, human and AI cooperative, AI led or AI centric? Identify and explain your choice in your own words in at least one paragraph.

I am currently studying information technology. I would categorize the work as human-led. AI in the form it is in currently does not have the reach needed to take over my job because much of what I would be doing in my field is physical (installing servers, configuring and troubleshooting networking equipment). In much of my field, AI can be very helpful. It can make things like generating documentation as well as writing and debugging scripts much less of a hassle. It is not quite human and AI cooperative because I would totally be able to do my job without AI.

3. Refer to the article "The Jobs that Artificial Intelligence will Create". How would you categorize the work you will be doing: trainers, explainers or sustainers? (You may need to stretch your thinking). Identify and explain your choice in your own words in at least one paragraph.

I see my work in information technology to potentially be a mix of all three categories but probably a bias in the explainer role. A large part of IT is proposing to the executives of a company certain technologies that will help reach business goals. With the rise of AI, things such as LLMs will surely become one of the technologies that will be proposed to advance the company. We will need to explain things like the problem that AI solutions will address, the specific technologies that will be used, and the computing resources that we will need to host those technologies.

4. Based on all of this investigation, what skills do you have and what skills do you think you may need to work in the AI future?

Although my education has not really touched on AI, I have a few skills that align me with it. I understand technologies such as LLMs to a decent extent. This gives me the insight to understand its applications, limitations, hardware requirements, software requirements, and avenues for development to reach a company's goals. I am trying to teach myself machine learning at a lower level to truly understand it and to better know where I can fit it to accomplish tasks. Next semester, I plan to take a linear algebra course because tensor operations are fundamental to deep learning, and deep neural networks interest me. I need to look deeper into the process of training models and optimizing it.

5. How does this all make you feel? Are you feeling anxious? Good? Determined? Prepared? Explain in your own words in at least one paragraph. End on a positive note - "I can remain relevant in an AI future because....."

I feel anxious to add more machine learning and AI to my skillset, but I am not extremely anxious that it will take my job. I feel that as long as I have skills with AI and showcase

them, it will be harder to replace me with it. I can remain relevant in an AI future because I can aid in the healthy and effective adoption of AI to reach business goals.

References

OpenAI. (2025). *ChatGPT* (May 14 version) [Large language model].
<https://chat.openai.com>.